50TH ANNIVERSARY

MODI ERA
2015-2025

BJP CMs

# BETTING ON FRESH FACES

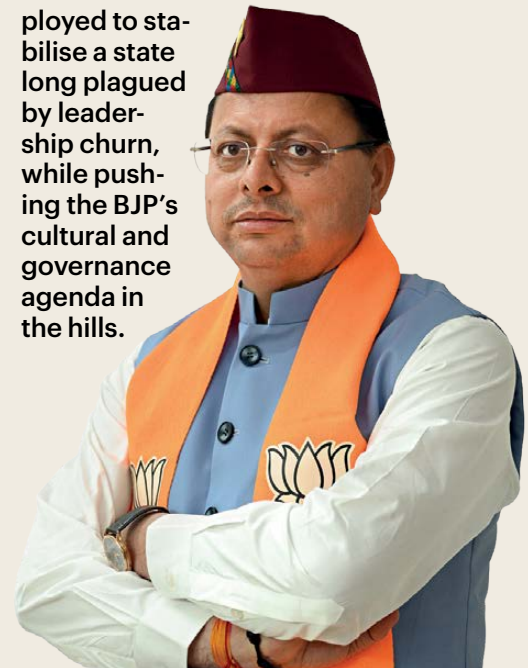
**Breaking old satrapies, the BJP's national leadership elevated a series of surprise picks to run key states**

**Over the past two decades**, power in several states had congealed around entrenched satraps, often stifling the rise of new leaders and hardening factional lines within the BJP. It is to arrest this drift that the Modi–Shah leadership has undertaken a nuanced experiment in political and social engineering—steadily dismantling the era of towering regional strongmen and replacing them with younger, more diverse chief ministers valued less for mass charisma than for organisational discipline, administrative reliability and fidelity to the central command.

## PUSHKAR SINGH DHAMI, *50*

*Uttarakhand CM since July 2021*

Young, combative and media-savvy, Dhami has been deployed to stabilise a state long plagued by leadership churn, while pushing the BJP's cultural and governance agenda in the hills.



ARUN KUMAR

## MOHAN YADAV, *60*

*Madhya Pradesh CM since December 2023*

**Known for his ideological alignment and quick decision-making, this OBC leader represents continuity with the Shivraj Singh Chouhan era without inheriting its political baggage.**



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

## MOHAN CHARAN MAJHI, *53*

*Odisha CM since June 2024*

A Santhal leader who entered politics as a sarpanch, Majhi's rise reflects the BJP's long-term investment in cadre-building and tribal outreach in a state long dominated by the BJD.

